A Letter From Your Future Self

Level 6 · Strategic Goals and Planning

Name _____ Date _____

Your brain responds to a vividly imagined experience in many of the same ways it responds to a real one. When you rehearse success in detail, the path towards it starts to feel familiar rather than frightening. In this exercise you will step forward in time to the moment you have achieved your goal. You will walk back through each phase of the journey, and then, as the successful you, write a letter to the person you are today, who is just about to begin.

The future you is not a stranger. It is who you become when you keep going.

PART 1 Step Into the Future

Close your eyes for a moment. Imagine the day you realise you have done it. Then describe what you see.

THE DATE

It is …

WHAT YOU HAVE ACHIEVED

I have …

What does an ordinary day look like now?

Where are you? Who is around you? What has changed in how you work, lead, or live?

How do you feel, and how do you see yourself?

Notice how you carry yourself and how you speak about yourself now.

PART 2 Walk Back Through the Journey

Looking back from the future, remember each phase. What happened, and what got you through it?

The beginning

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT HELPED ME THROUGH

The middle, when it got hard

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT HELPED ME THROUGH

The turning point

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT HELPED ME THROUGH

Arriving

WHAT HAPPENED

WHAT HELPED ME THROUGH

PART 3 Your Letter

Now write as the future you, to the you who is about to start. Speak with warmth and honesty. You know things now that you did not know then.

BEGIN YOUR LETTER

Dear …

What I want you to know before you start

The encouragement you most need to hear right now.

The advice that would have saved me time

What to focus on, what to let go of, and what to do first.

What to do when you want to give up

There will be a moment like this. Tell yourself what to remember.

What you can stop worrying about

The fears that never came true, or did not matter as much as you thought.

What I am most proud of you for

SIGN YOUR LETTER

With love, from …

PART 4 Read It Back

Read your letter slowly, as the person receiving it.

What stands out as you read it?

One recommendation you will act on this week

Take one piece of your own advice and put it into practice now.

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